



India Responds

ASK NOW

India is dogged by a lack of clarity in its preparedness and response to the nefarious designs of terrorists. The War on Terror needs that definition of purpose and specific goals. INDIA TODAY's panel of experts addresses that need, answering reader's queries and offering solutions.



LALIT MANSINGH
Former foreign
secretary

If the US can demolish Iraq after the 9/11 attack, why is India proving itself a weak state against terrorism?

NIRAJ, (niraj2010@hotmail.com)

The American attack on Iraq has not been a great success. India has, in fact, defeated Pakistan in every war. Going to war with Pakistan is not a smart idea as it carries the risk of a military takeover of Pakistan or its disintegration. We should focus on breaking the nexus between the Pakistani Army and terrorists.



B. RAMAN
Former additional
secretary R&AW

Is it true that R&AW's assets have deteriorated in Pakistan?

PARTH, (parth_aggarwal@hotmail.com)

R&AW has seen a decline in its performance and has few counter-terrorism experts. There's a lack of investment in research and development and over-secrecy kills interaction with experts. Indira Gandhi had wanted it to be an action-oriented agency but since 1997, it has become a purely intelligence collection agency. It urgently needs counter-terrorism experts from other agencies.



KAPIL KAK
Retired air marshal
and joint director,
Centre for Air Power
Studies

Who are our threats, Pakistanis across the border or Indians supporting Pakistan here?

PRANAV,

(pranav_dwivedi2003@yahoo.com)

One should avoid jingoism. We should engage with our neighbourhood and integrate it economically and culturally, rather than contain it. The region should sustain peace and security for India's primary driver—socio-economic growth and the development of its poor. We should focus on people-to-people exchanges.



GURMEET KANWAL
Retired brigadier
and director of
Centre for Land
Warfare Studies

What is the Government's strategy for eliminating sleeper cells?

SUSHANTH, (sushanth_dk@yahoo.com)

Intelligence agencies are aware of the existence of sleeper cells and some have been eliminated also. However, it is only by stepping up 'humint' (human intelligence) and penetrating the HQs of these modules that sufficient information about them can be acquired. Most ex-servicemen, who retire young, can be trained as IB agents.

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their answers now.
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India's Views

Offence is the best defence. On noticing suspicious elements roaming around, we should apprehend them and hand them over to the police or paramilitary forces for further questioning.

RIBU KUMAR SINGH, *Allahabad*

Politicians with criminal records should not be given tickets to fight elections. We will have half of our problems solved.

ASHESH, *Mumbai*

Even God cannot save India until young Indians take responsibility to cleanse public life. Corrupt public servants must be given a warning before they are taken to task. Only dedicated grassroots workers can change India. Bring firebrand Indian youth into mainstream politics.

DEEPAK, *USA*

We should deploy our forces on our borders with our firepower pointed towards key terrorist outfits and the main army bases of Pakistan. Then we should tell Pakistan to hand over all the terrorists to us who have been involved directly or indirectly against India. Else, we should make them clear that we will get them on our own even if it means invading Pakistani territory. In case the world community says anything, we should remind them about the American invasion of Iraq and Afghanistan.

NETRAPAL SINGH PANGHAL, *Pune*

When India started its journey as an independent nation, a Constitution, derived from the American and British laws, was handed over to us. But these countries never faced the situations that we face. They have no neighbouring enemies, neither have they faced infiltration nor do they have home-grown terrorism. The Constitution of India, therefore, should be amended, rather changed, in order to make it capable of fighting terror.

SHAHNAWAZ KHAN, *Noida*